appointed Alternate Governor of the Fund and the Bank and also Executive Director of the Bank. Joshi was Executive Director on the Fund and initially no Alternate Executive Director was appointed but that changed when it was soon realized that full-time Alternates were essential. B.K. Madan was appointed as Alternate at the Fund and Joshi at the Bank and soon after Madan became Alternate for both the Fund and the Bank. Madan succeeded Joshi as Executive Director at the Fund and Madan's place as Alternate was taken by D.S. Savkar of the RBI. In January 1950, Joshi became Executive Director of the Fund once again.

There is an interesting anecdote about the first meeting of the Executive Board of the World Bank. Representing Great Britain was none other than Sir James Grigg while Sundaresan, who had worked under Grigg in the Finance Department, represented a still dependent India. The irrepressible Grigg looked at Sundaresan and observed: 'Sandy, how has life changed. Have I fallen so low or have you risen so high that we should be sharing the same table.' Sundaresan's riposte of 'Both, Sir James' proved that brevity is indeed the soul of wit. Now that they were quits, Grigg asked if India and Britain could have a coordinated strategy for board agendas. Sundaresan promised to revert after consulting the Government of India. Grigg told him: 'Sandy, do not take directions from Whitehall, repeat not; Delhi will advise as and when necessary.'[47]

Also connected with India's membership of the Fund was the fixing of the par value of the rupee in November 1946. India's ties with sterling were symbolically snapped and Deshmukh discussed this question fully in a meeting in New Delhi where he presented the views of the RBI. Prof. D.R. Gadgil was one of the experts invited and government decided to maintain the existing exchange parity of the rupee at 4.145142857 grain of fine gold in line with the decisions of most other countries, and keeping in mind the prevailing uncertainties.